

THE "CrossTechXperience" HACKATHON RULEBOOK

Cross-border Hackathon to Foster Innovation

CONTEXT:

This Hackathon is organized as part of the Interreg France-Wallonia-Flanders-0100161 project – CrossTechXperience (CTX), to activate collective creativity across the regions involved. The overarching objective is to foster relationships between students from different regions through collaborative working sessions while building and/or strengthening links with companies interested in the developments achieved.

The purpose of this document is to provide a transparent and equitable framework for your participation in this hackathon. The Regulation also provides the main guidelines on how to conduct the hackathon competition. The Regulations are applied by the staff involved in the activities of organizing the hackathon.

1- TERMINOLOGY

Hackathon: The CTX competition organized between several teams with the goal of stimulating technological innovation and industrial transfer focused on interactive, immersive, and gaming technologies.

Organizer: The Hackathon is organized by the partners of the project and will take place at Le CLICK, located at Boulevard Initialis, 30, 7000 Mons, Belgique. The other contact persons are:

- dave.van.verdegem@howest.be,
- loic.reboursiere@umons.ac.be,
- leila.glinka@technocite.be.

Partners: The entities involved in the smooth running of the event, including but not limited to sponsors; industrial partners; academic partners, students, etc.

Hackathon team: A team of four to six students, usually with complementary skills and knowledge, entered in the hackathon competition.

Sponsor: a company with professional knowledge in technology and / or other sectors of activity relevant to one of the themes of the competition and who, during its development, offers advice / guidance to a team (or several) entered in the competition.

2- PURPOSE

This event aims to create positive synergies between project Partners from learning and research institutions (schools, universities, training centre) and companies from the three regions (France, Wallonie, Vlaanderen), with the goal of stimulating technological innovation and industrial transfer focused on interactive, immersive, and gaming technologies.

Participants (students, freelancers, artists, etc., from the region of interest of the Interreg France-Wallonia-Flanders program) will make a community of researchers, designers, 3D artists, game designers, developers, etc., and work in teams of 4 to 6 people on projects proposed by companies.

This document establishes the rules of participation to ensure that all participants are informed of:

- The use of permissive open-source licenses;
- The use of results;
- Management of personal data;
- Confidentiality and non-Disclosure;
- Management of IP rights;
- Recognition of each Partner's contribution;
- The choice to waive IP rights, ensuring no party claims ownership of IP.

3- CONDITIONS OF PARTICIPATION

By registering for this event, participants (companies, researchers, students, etc.) agree to participate in the entire Hackathon and comply with these rules.

Participation requires completing the registration form available on the event's dedicated website via the following link: <https://vivid-handspring-601.notion.site/27fd794de62580eeb2efd41a69037796?pvs=105>.

The Hackathon will span two and a half days, during which 10 teams, each comprising 4 to 6 participants from each region, will compete and collaborate on pre-selected themes in the presence of local industrial partners.

Registration implies irrevocable acceptance of these Rules.

Participating companies will be selected cross-borderly by the partners, aiming for balanced representation from all regions. These companies will be drawn from the networks of project partners or the Inspiration Session event on October 23, 2025. Selected companies indicate interest in the projects but receive no financial consideration or IP rights at this stage.

Selection criteria, defined jointly by project partners, may include innovation, thematic relevance, industrial needs, market potential, commercial ambition, and cross-border added value.

Participants must indicate their university and region of origin upon arrival on the first day.

Participants ensure their presence for the entire duration of the Hackathon and any related extensions.

4- ORGANIZATION

4.1 Duration - Location

The Hackathon will take place over two and a half days, from December 5th at 2PM to December 7th at 7PM, 2025, in person at Le CLICK, Boulevard Initialis, 30, 7000 Mons, Belgique.

4.2 Schedule

- Friday, December 5, 2025: Projects introduction by companies, team setup and project selection. Work begins after team assignments.
- Saturday, December 6, 2025: Work on the project. Awareness session on open-source licenses and IP-related aspects of their contributions. Specific technological workshops.
- Sunday, December 7, 2025: Prototype development and project presentations to a jury of experts. The event concludes with awards for the top three projects, followed by a networking reception.

4.3 Team Formation

Teams of 4 to 6 participants will form based on needed profiles and inspiring keywords associated with the projects. Project descriptions will be prepared by project operators to provide sufficient detail and inspire creativity. After team formation, a company representative or project team member will answer any questions. Participants may switch projects during the Q&A session if team sizes are respected.

Coaches will guide participants throughout the weekend on ideation, project framing, and progress. A group of technical experts from project partners will assist with technical elements, such as XR technologies.

4.4 Winner Selection

A jury of members of the project's institutions representatives will select the top three results for further development.

Selection criteria include innovation, thematic alignment, industrial needs, market potential, commercial ambition, and cross-border value.

4.5 Cost of Participation

The Organizer provides meals for all participants over the two and a half days and offers two night's accommodation (Friday, December 5 to Sunday, December 7, 2025) at a local hotel. Participants must indicate their interest in this accommodation during registration or via email to:

- dave.van.verdegem@howest.be,
- loic.reboursiere@umons.ac.be,
- leila.glinka@technocite.be.

Other costs (e.g., travel expenses) are not covered or reimbursed by the Organizer.

5- INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

5.1 General Provisions

Participants acknowledge that the Organizer's goal is to foster innovation and encourage the open-source distribution of solutions. The Organizer assumes no liability for any disputes or claims related to intellectual property arising from Hackathon outcomes. Participants are solely responsible for ensuring the originality of their work and guarantee that their projects do not infringe upon the intellectual property rights of any third party.

5.2 Permissive Open-Source license Principle

Participants retain full ownership of any intellectual property (IP) they develop during the Hackathon. Unless explicitly stated otherwise, all outcomes of the Hackathon will be released under a permissive open-source license designated by the Organizer, enabling free use, modification, and distribution. Participants are encouraged to use pre-existing software, 3D models, APIs, or AI tools that are open source to align with this principle.

5.3 Exceptional Cases

If technologies, software components, sound or video recordings, pictures or datasets are subject to specific licenses prohibiting open-source release, the Organizer will notify participants, and these elements will be excluded from open-source publication.

Participants must disclose pre-existing IP to the Organizer.

In cases where certain technologies, software components, sound or video recordings, pictures or datasets are governed by licenses or copyrights that restrict open-source distribution, the

Organizer and the Participant will inform each other in advance. These specific elements will not be included in the open-source release of Hackathon outcomes. Participants are required to disclose any pre-existing intellectual property they intend to use in their projects to the Organizer prior to the Hackathon. Failure to disclose pre-existing IP may result in disqualification or other consequences as determined by the Organizer.

5.4 Use of Organizer's Resources

If the Organizer provides proprietary resources (e.g., APIs, tools, or datasets) for use during the Hackathon, participants agree to comply with the specific terms of use accompanying these resources. The Organizer retains ownership of such resources, and participants are granted a limited, non-transferable license to use them solely for the purpose of the Hackathon.

6- USE OF HACKATHON RESULTS

6.1 Negotiation of usage licenses

Enterprises or Participants interested in utilizing Hackathon outcomes subject to specific licences may negotiate usage licenses in good faith with the intellectual property owners (if any), considering the added value and potential commercial or social impact of the solutions. All licensing agreements must respect the principles of transparency and fairness and comply with the terms of the open-source license (if applicable) under which the outcomes are published.

6.2 Open-Source accessibility

Hackathon outcomes published under an open-source license remain accessible to all parties according to the terms of the designated license. No additional licensing fees shall apply for the use of such outcomes under open-source terms, and any modifications or derivative works must comply with the original license's obligations, such as attribution or share-alike requirements.

6.3 Commercialization support

The Organizer may facilitate opportunities for participants to commercialize the Hackathon outcomes by connecting them with relevant stakeholders, such as investors, incubators, or enterprises. However, such facilitation does not imply ownership, endorsement, or liability on the part of the Organizer.

6.4 Use of Results for educational or research purposes

The Parties involved in the Hackathon reserve the right to use Hackathon outcomes (e.g., prototypes, ideas, or reports) for educational, research, or promotional purposes, provided such use does not violate the ownership rights of the participants or any applicable licenses.

7- PRIVACY & RIGHTS TO PUBLIC IMAGE

Participants authorize the Organizer to use their images, voices, and any recordings or photographs taken during the event for promotional purposes, including but not limited to social media, websites, brochures, and other marketing materials. Participants who wish to opt out of this authorization must notify the Organizer in writing no later than seven (7) days prior to the event. The Organizer will make reasonable efforts to accommodate such requests but cannot guarantee exclusion from all media captured in group settings or during public activities.

8- USE OF CROSSTECHXPERIENCE BRANDING AND INTERREG LOGO

8.1 CrossTechXperience Branding and Logo

Participants must use the provided CrossTechXperience logo using the branding guidelines, referring to the Interreg program.

9- CONFIDENTIALITY

9.1 Definition of confidential information

For the purposes of this rulebook, "confidential information" refers to any non-public, proprietary, or sensitive information disclosed during the Hackathon, whether verbally, in writing, or through other means, including but not limited to trade secrets, business plans, technical data, prototypes, algorithms, source code, datasets, or other intellectual property.

9.2 Obligation of non-disclosure

Participants agree to treat all confidential information disclosed during the Hackathon as strictly confidential and not to disclose, share, reproduce, or use such information for any purpose outside the scope of the Hackathon without prior written authorization from the disclosing party.

9.3 Exceptions to confidentiality

The obligation of confidentiality does not apply to information that:

- Was already in the public domain at the time of disclosure.
- Becomes publicly available through no fault of the Participant.
- Is rightfully received from a third party without breach of any obligation of confidentiality.
- Was independently developed by the participant without use of or reference to the disclosed confidential information.

9.4 Consequences of breach

Any breach of confidentiality by a Participant may result in immediate exclusion from the Hackathon and disqualification from receiving any prizes or recognition. Additionally, the Organizer or the affected party reserves the right to pursue legal action, including but not limited to claims for damages or injunctive relief, as applicable.

9.5 Duration of confidentiality obligations

The confidentiality obligations set forth in this clause shall remain in effect for a period of three (3) years following the conclusion of the Hackathon, unless otherwise agreed in writing by the disclosing party.

9.6 Organizer's responsibility

The Organizer commits to treating any proprietary information shared by Participants with the same level of confidentiality. Any sensitive information disclosed to the Organizer for evaluation, feedback, or support purposes will not be shared with third parties without the participant's explicit consent.

10- GDPR COMPLIANCE

The Organizer is committed to protecting Participants' personal data in compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). Personal data collected during the Hackathon will be processed exclusively for organizational, reporting, and promotional purposes related to the event.

Participants explicitly consent to the collection, storage, and processing of their personal data for these purposes by registering for the Hackathon.

Participants may exercise their GDPR rights (e.g., access, rectification, erasure, restriction of processing) by contacting the Organizer through the provided communication channels.

11- LIABILITY

Participants are solely responsible for any damage, loss, or injury they cause to themselves, other Participants, equipment, or venue facilities during the Hackathon.

The Organizer disclaims all liability for any indirect, incidental, or consequential damages incurred during or as a result of the Hackathon.

The Organizer is not liable for modifications, delays, or cancellations of the event due to force majeure, including but not limited to natural disasters, strikes, health crises, or unforeseen technical issues.

12- VALIDITY OF RULES

Participation in the Hackathon implies full acceptance of these Rules, which constitute a binding agreement between the Participants and the Organizer.

If any provision of these Rules is deemed invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions will remain in full force and effect.

13- GOVERNING LAW AND JURISDICTION

These Rules are governed by Belgian law.

Any disputes arising from the Hackathon shall fall under the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts located in Mons, Belgium.